

McMaster University Research Ethics Board (MREB)

c/o Research Office for Administrative Development and Support
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CERTIFICATE OF ETHICS CLEARANCE TO INVOLVE HUMAN PARTICIPANTS IN RESEARCH

Today's Date: Jun/22/2026

Principal Investigator: Dr. Spencer Smith

PI Faculty/Dept: Engineering - Computing and Software

Co-Investigator: Dr. Jacques Carette, Dr. Matthew Giamou, Dr. Lingyang Chu

Student Investigator: Mr Ziyang Fang, Mr. Christopher Schankula

Applicant: Spencer Smith

Project Title: The State of the Practice for Research Software

MREB#: 8215

Dear Researcher(s)

The ethics application and supporting documents for MREB# 8215 entitled "The State of the Practice for Research Software" have been reviewed and cleared by the MREB to ensure compliance with the Tri-Council Policy Statement and the McMaster Policies and Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants.

The application is cleared as presented without questions or requests for modifications. The above named study is to be conducted in accordance with the most recent approved versions of the application and supporting documents.

Ongoing clearance is contingent on completing the Annual Report in advance of the yearly anniversary of the original ethics clearance date: Jun/22/2027. If the Annual Report is not submitted, then ethics clearance will lapse on the expiry date and Research Finance will be notified that ethics clearance is no longer valid (TCPS, Art. 6.14).

An Amendment form must be submitted and cleared before any substantive alterations are made to the approved research protocol and documents (TCPS, Art. 6.16).

Researchers are required to report Adverse Events (i.e. an unanticipated negative consequence or result affecting participants) to the MREB secretariat and the MREB Chair as soon as possible, and no more than 3 days after the event occurs (TCPS, Art. 6.15). A privacy breach affecting participant information should also be reported to the MREB secretariat and the MREB Chair as soon as possible. The Reportable Events form is used to document adverse events, privacy breaches, protocol deviations and participant complaints.

Document Type	File Name	Date	Version
Response Documents	SummaryOfRevisions2	Jun/18/2026	2
Recruiting Materials	RecruitingScript	Jun/18/2026	3
Recruiting Materials	RecruitingScript_FollowUpEmail	Jun/18/2026	3
Recruiting Materials	ThankYouScript	Jun/18/2026	3
Interviews	InterviewGuide	May/11/2026	1
Consent Forms	ConsentLog	May/11/2026	1
Consent Forms	Oral-Consent-Script	Jun/18/2026	3
Consent Forms	Letter-of-Information-Consent-Form2	Jun/18/2026	3

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